Jainism was present as evidenced by the caves with Tamil-Brahmi inscriptions. Performance of *Yagna* is also evidenced. Buddhism was also present in certain centres. Different groups practiced various forms of worship.

3.8 Fine Arts

Various art forms too existed in the Sangam Age. Performances of ritual dances called Veriyatal are referred to in the literature. Composition of poems, playing of music instruments and dances were also known. The literature mentions the fine variety of cuisine of the Sangam Age. People took care of their appearance and evidence of antimony rods (kohl sticks) made of copper has been found in archaeological sites. They were used by women for decorating their eyebrows.



Antimony rods (kohlsticks) were made of bronze



Copper rods used for decorating eyelashes

Pattanam, Kerala

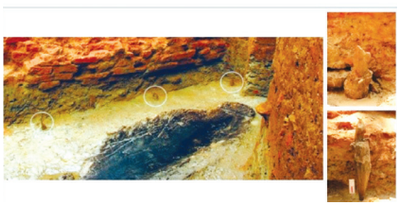
Pattanam is located near North Paravur in Vadakkekara village of Ernakulam district of Kerala. It was an ancient port town that had overseas connections with the western and eastern worlds.



Pottery sherds from West Asia



Cameo blanks in Carnelian



Canoe excavated at Pattanam



Gold ornaments from Pattanam



Turquoise glazed pottery, West Asia

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